

11.2 Data collection methods, fieldwork safety and equipment

- 1** Match the following types of questions found on questionnaires, a–c, to their definitions, 1–3.
- | | |
|--------------------------|--|
| a multiple-choice | 1 longer, and more unique, answers can be given |
| b closed | 2 respondents have a choice of answers |
| c open | 3 answers are limited, e.g. 'yes' or 'no' |
- b** Write an example question to match each question type.
- 2** Decide if the following statements are true or false. If they are false, correct them:
- a** An enquiry checklist only needs to include primary data collection methods.
 - b** Closed questions allow respondents to give longer, opinion-based answers.
 - c** A pilot study can help avoid issues with question clarity.
 - d** Interviews are less expensive and faster to conduct than questionnaires.
 - e** Questionnaires can be done face-to-face, online or over the phone.

3 Read the following scenario and then answer Questions a to c below:

A team of geography students is preparing a field trip to investigate the impact of tourism in a coastal town. They plan to use questionnaires to gather data from tourists and interviews with local shop owners.

- a** Identify three preparations the students should include in their fieldwork checklist.
- b** What are the potential challenges of using questionnaires with tourists, and how can they address these challenges?
- c** Suggest one advantage and one disadvantage of interviewing local shop owners compared to using questionnaires with tourists.

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UNDERSTAND THESE TERMS

- Pilot study
- Random sampling
- Systematic sampling
- Primary data
- Secondary data

4 What is the difference between:

- a** random sampling and systematic sampling?
- b** primary and secondary data?

5 A student is investigating how people feel about new sea defences that have been put in place along the coastline. Devise

two relevant questions that could be included in a questionnaire. [2]

- 6 A fieldwork group wants to investigate the width and depth of a river at several points along its course. Suggest a method to accurately measure these characteristics. [4]

- 7 Copy the following text and complete by choosing the correct word in the brackets.

Taking part in fieldwork poses risks and (**hazards/questions**) that need to be identified before the investigation starts. To ensure clear and effective communication, always share (**location/contact**) details and work in pairs or groups. Environmental conditions to consider include (**clothing/walking**) appropriately, using (**sunblock/resources**), and avoiding dangerous areas.

- 8 Read the following scenario and answer Questions a to c below:
A group of students is conducting fieldwork near a river. They are collecting data using transects and taking photographs. They notice the riverbank is steep, and one student has a bee allergy.

- a Identify three potential risks in this scenario.
- b Suggest three ways the group can address these risks to ensure safety during their fieldwork.
- c What additional equipment or preparation might be needed for this location?

- 9 Read the following scenario and answer Questions a to d below:
A team of students is conducting fieldwork in a forested area to survey plant biodiversity. They are using quadrats to collect data and they are taking field sketches. The area is isolated with uneven terrain, some parts are muddy, and there are reports of ticks in the area.

- a Identify three potential risks in this scenario.

- b** Suggest three ways the group can address these risks to ensure safety during their fieldwork.
- c** How might the students in this scenario use quadrats?
- d** What additional equipment or preparation might be needed for this location?

~~10~~ Suggest a checklist to ensure safety during a fieldwork study taking place in a city centre. [4]

~~11~~ A geography teacher is planning a fieldwork trip to study coastal erosion. Suggest three safety measures that should be considered before the trip. [3]

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◀◀ RECALL AND CONNECT 2 ◀◀

Sand dune ecosystems are located along coastlines. The density and diversity of plant species within sand dunes increase with distance from the shoreline. These two variables can be measured using a quadrat, which is a square that can be placed over short vegetation, making it easier to quantify and identify species. See if you can answer the following questions about sand dune ecosystems linked to [Topic 2, 'Coastal environments'](#).

- a** Are sand dunes landforms of erosion or deposition?
- b** Are sand dunes formed by waves or the wind?

UNDERSTAND THIS TERM

- Quadrat